

## 10.1

**What is curriculum and what its significance is**

Why curriculum occupies a significant position in the educative process

Instruction is not possible without curriculum. Give your arguments in favor of statement.

In formal schooling, curriculum is the set of courses and their contents offered at an educational institution. As an idea, curriculum stems from the Latin word for 'race course', referring to the course of deeds and experiences through which children grow and mature in becoming adults. The term 'curriculum' was first used by the Scottish in 1820. In the beginning, this word was used in the meaning of 'riding but with the passage of time, it began to be used in sense of 'course of study'. On contrary, the Greek used this word in the sense of development of abilities. This passage reveals that the concept of curriculum has been repeatedly changing from time to time.....According to some other historical traditions, the term 'curriculum' implies an 'athletic ground'. Thus, it indicates that curriculum is the ground through which the educand has to pass in order to reach a definite goal. In the remote past, this term was also taken to mean a collection of knowledge and skill. But the modern interpretation of the term is clarified by many experts who suggest that the curriculum is the organized form of subject-matter, specially prepared to meet the requirements of the students. Now, curriculum includes those activities, experiences, and skills which provide the students with the abilities and skills they will require in facing the various situation of real life. To me, the term 'curriculum' cannot be restricted to the list of books or subjects because it must include other activities and the social environment of the school and other elements which are not taught in books. Curriculum, in its broadest sense, includes the complete school environment involving academic books, activities, reading skills and associations furnished to the students in the educational institutions. Here are some established and representative definitions of curriculum.....

- Curriculum is a blend of such activities, skills and behavior which are arranged and developed for the fertilization of pre-determined objectives of education.
- Curriculum is a work schedule or a body of experiences that lies between objectives and teaching styles.
- Curriculum is the whole body of courses of studies offered to the students.
- Curriculum refers to the selection of subject-matter to be taught.
- Curriculum is an activity-oriented comprehensive strategy which aims at developing the students in line with the objectives of education.
- Curriculum is a plan for learning.
- Curriculum is a combination of those activities, skill and attitudes which are organized for the realization of the pre-determined objectives of education.



• Curriculum consist of the courses of studies offered in the instructional activities of the school. • Curriculum is a set of contents for the teachers and learners in the class room. • Curriculum refers to the practical steps to be taken for the attainment of educational objectives. • Curriculum is a menu of opportunities that allows a student to develop the thinking and skills necessary to succeed in life and to pursue mental and physical well being. • Curriculum is an essential body of skills and knowledge which enables the students to continue the acquisition of new knowledge and additional skills. • Curriculum is a body of knowledge that is a framework and guides to allow students to reach their potential. It teaches them skills needed to survive as productive citizens. • Curriculum is a process of learning and discovery which utilizes any means necessary to enhance students' abilities to recognize and explore their ignorance. • Curriculum refers to the planned experiences provided through instruction, which enable the school to meet its aims. The significance of curriculum is highlighted under the following subheadings:

**Curriculum is a tool for attaining objectives:** Curriculum is the way which leads to the acquisition of the objectives of education. 'Objectives of education' is just a purposeless document if it is not supported by curriculum. What do we expect from the students. These are the objectives of a system of education which are realized through a formal curriculum.

**Curriculum is a foundation of formal education:** Every nation designs a formal system of education for its individuals. The national objectives cannot be obtained without a system of education. These objectives can only be achieved if a formal curriculum is taught in the formal educational institutions. The establishment of these institutions indicates that the nation has formulated a strategy for the education of its individuals. This very strategy is termed as 'curriculum'.

**Curriculum is concerned with the development of individuals:** The core aim of curriculum is to develop the personality of the individuals so that they may play their role which the society expects from them. An individual comes across various learning experiences by means of the curricular activities. These learning experiences bring about all-round personality development. Here a reality is unfolded that curriculum has direct concern with the personality development of the students.

**Curriculum gives birth to the required individuals:** A system of education fixes the responsibility on curriculum to produce such individuals as are needed for various fields of social life. These required individuals play their role in the development and prosperity of the society. The objectives of education decide the sort of individuals which are to be produced by means of the educative process.



**Curriculum transmits human heritage:** The academic excellences, experiences and other human achievements are preserved through transmission to the next generations. By means of the transmission of human academic heritage, the man of today is more developed than that of the past. Curriculum is the tool for the transmission of human heritage to the forthcoming generations and thereby it paves the way to the realization of the development dream of humanity.

**Social stability is concerned with curriculum:** Social stability is considered the most important aim of every system of education. This aim can only be realized if the individuals of a nation are acquainted with the social values and changes by means of curriculum. The individuals cannot understand the social needs without curriculum. Curriculum provides those civilized citizens which are essential for the social stability.

**Curriculum is a guide to the educative process:** Curriculum determines the limits and scope of the educative process. It points out the duties of a teacher. It further points out the activities which must be conducted for the realization of the objectives of education. All these affairs are concerned with curriculum. It is guide to a teacher and to a student as well. It tells the teachers and the students the determined role for which they strive for. There is no concept of the instructional process without curriculum. If there is no instructional process, there is no justification for the existence of teacher and student.

**Curriculum is the justification of the training process:** A system of education is designed for the training of individuals. This training is carried out in the light of curriculum. Curriculum decides the skills and behavioral changes to be brought about in the character of the individuals. A teacher cannot know his/her responsibilities regarding the students without curriculum. In this way, it seems true to state that curriculum is the foundation and justification of the process of training.

**Curriculum is means for achieving individual and collective goals:** Life aims of an individual and nation are closely associated with curriculum. A person has to go through various curricular activities for personality development and promotion of faculties. In this way, he/she gets the goal of social adjustment. A socially adjusted person plays a significant role in the acquisition of collective aims. A nation is composed of individuals. When a person gets his/her personal aims. These personal aims are, in fact, a part of the collective aims.

**Curriculum prepares for meeting the demands of changing environment:** The society is constantly changing. Human needs are also continuously changing. The scientific development has influenced the life style. The continual change is a significant trait of this modern age. The demands of life are changing in the changing social scenario. Curriculum absorbs



these demands and thereby enables the individual to cope with the modern needs. If there is no curriculum, an individual cannot keep himself/herself abreast of the recent needs.

10.2

old

alternative (traditional) concept of curriculum